

More solar, more electronics to manage its energy

The Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, launched in 2024, received an 80% budget hike to ₹200 billion for FY26. The programme aims to increase solar-powered households from 800,000 to 10 million by 2027, backed by a ₹750.21 billion outlay and installation subsidies of up to 40%.

With solar power costs dropping, the government's sustainability push demands an electronics sector transformation to handle this energy shift. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman introduced the 'National Manufacturing Mission' to drive innovation in solar PV cells, EV batteries, and grid-scale storage solutions. Emphasising self-reliance, she highlighted a focus on high-tech sectors that complement renewable energy growth, including electrolyzers for hydrogen production, wind turbines, and ultra-high-voltage transmission equipment.

All that is for startups and innovation...

The Union Budget reinforced support for startups and MSMEs, extending the startup benefit window by five years, and allowing incorporation until April 1, 2030. A new ₹100 billion 'Fund of Funds' will further bolster startups, supplementing the ₹910 billion already committed to Alternate Investment Funds (AIFs).

To drive next-gen innovation, a 'Deep Tech Fund of Funds' is also under consideration. With an increased credit guarantee cover enabling ₹1.5 trillion in additional funding over the next five years, credit access for MSMEs and startups will expand.

The Finance Minister also announced an Export Promotion Mission, with sectoral and ministerial targets led by the Ministries of Commerce, MSME, and Finance. The initiative aims to improve export credit access, provide cross-border factoring support, and help MSMEs navigate non-tariff barriers in global markets.

Sarvagya Mishra, founder and director at Superbot, a Gurugram-based AI-tech company, welcomed the government's focus on skill development. "We particularly commend the ₹5 billion Centre of Excellence for AI in Education. The Deep Tech Fund of Funds is another major step toward fostering innovation," he noted.

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